Previous Production Incident Report

Fictional training evidence - INC-2026-011

Incident ID	INC-2026-011
Service	Customer Portal
Related Component	Customer API Service / CustomerDB
Severity	SEV-2
Date	March 2026

Incident Summary

Following scheduled database maintenance, CustomerDB returned to service and database health checks passed. Customer Portal users nevertheless experienced intermittent transaction failures for approximately 42 minutes.

Observed Symptoms

- Database service was online and accepting administrative connections.
- Some Customer API requests returned database connectivity errors.
- Customer Portal transactions failed intermittently.
- Restarting the Customer API Service restored normal transaction processing.

Root Cause

The Customer API Service retained stale pooled database connections after the database restart. Database-only health checks did not identify the application-layer connectivity issue.

Corrective Actions

- Add application-layer connectivity validation after database maintenance.
- Recycle the Customer API connection pool when database restart invalidates existing sessions.
- Include end-to-end business transaction validation before declaring maintenance successful.

Lessons Learned

Database availability alone is not sufficient evidence of service readiness. Validation should include the application integration layer and an end-to-end business transaction.